

Chemistry—The Wikipedia Entry

<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chemistry>

Wikipedia needs no introduction. The Chemistry entry on Wikipedia will give you a good overview of the subject. This will help you keep The Big Picture in mind as you delve into the details.

An Introduction to Chemistry

<http://preparatorychemistry.com>

This well-organised site is the online version of the textbook *An Introduction to Chemistry* by Mark Bishop. Maintained and hosted by the author, the site is packed with tons of animations, tutorials, checklists, PowerPoint presentations, chapter maps, glossary quizzes, and “user-manipulatable” 3D representations of molecular structures. The content is primarily for students starting out on a college course in chemistry with no real background in the subject, but we feel this will be a good companion text to those who are tackling the eleventh and twelfth standard board exams as well.

The text comes in two versions—a “chemistry first” version and an “early conversions” version. The content remains the same, but with some rearrangement of the order of presentation. In the “chemistry first” version, mathematics-related topics have been pushed to later on in the book (chapter 8 and beyond), while the “early conversions” version treats those topics earlier in the book. You choose which version to go for, but the author stresses and favours “chemistry first.”

The site, as you can see from the screenshot, is organised into tabs on the top and links on the left sidebar. Both the tabs and the sidebar links take you to almost the same set of topics.

The textbook has been broken up into chapters which are downloadable PDFs. Additionally, each chapter has a “Concept Map” and a Study Guide PDF, which you can download separately. The concept map is a single-page diagram that encapsulates the concepts learnt in the chapter and their relationships. This makes it convenient when you want to revise and review your under-